



o d o



DAVID SHAW
DECEMBER 9TH, 2021

先付け

SAKIZUKE

兵庫県のセイコ蟹の茶碗蒸しと柚子
Chawanmushi of seikogani from Hyogo and yuzu

お椀

OWAN

九州の鰯の昆布白出汁
鰯と豆腐フライと穂紫蘇とニラ
Kombu shirodashi of Kyūshū shima aji with fried tofu, hojiso, and chives

焼き物

YAKIMONO

宮崎A5和牛のもも肉と甘だれと卵黄
Momoniku of Miyazaki A5 wagyu beef with amadare sauce and egg yolk

ちらし丼

CHIRASHIDON

ボストンのマグロの赤身とカマトロ、大分の真鯛、北海道の鰯、長崎のカツオ、紫蘇と干瓢
Boston tuna's akami and kamatoro cut, madai from Ōita, buri from Hokkaido, katsuo from Nagasaki, shiso and kanpyō

食事・蕎麦

SHOKUJI — SOBA

宮崎A5和牛のサーロインと胡麻と唐辛子
Sukiyaki style Miyazaki A5 wagyu beef sirloin with grounded sesame and togarashi pepper

デザート

DESSERT

ミルクアイスクリームと金柑と黒蜜
Milk ice cream with kumquat and black sugar



New York is one of the best places outside Japan's mainland to taste authentic sushi. However, with so many high-end sushi places in the city, there are only a few places where we can find authentic kaiseki cuisine. With the closure of Okuda and bar Uchū, o.d.o and Tsukimi are the only two restaurants in NYC that served exclusively kaiseki cuisine. Chef Hiroki Odo used to serve kaiseki dinner at a price as high as two hundred dollars. After the pandemic, he is currently offering a six-course kaiseki lunch at only \$125. o.d.o nestles in the flatiron district. Step into the restaurant, a classically decorated bar that resembles those Japanese-western bars or restaurants is right in front of my eye. Behind the golden metal threshold is the dining room, where the interior looks much more traditionally Japanese. The lunch experience unfolds smoothly after I am seated.



The next course is an owan course. The miso soup is a kombu shirodashi of Kyūshū shima aji and is served with baked shima aji, fried tofu, hojiso, and chives. The shirodashi is a light miso soup version but is still on the heavy side as the kombu introduces a condensed sophisticated taste in addition to the umami extracted from the shima aji. The fried tofu and baked shima aji add even more depth and heaviness to the melange, and the chives also carries a heavy aroma compared to other herbs. While the hojiso imparts a great deal of refreshment, it is still not enough to create a balance.

The quasi-kaiseki lunch unfolds on a simple chawanmushi dish with seikogani from Hyogo and yuzu. The egg custard is steamed to perfection, silky yet quivering. The seikogani is a female version of the matsubagani, and it carries a pristine sweetness that is so delicate and refreshing and is further amplified after the steaming process. The yuzu provides not only the essential acidity but the light sweetness as well that goes perfectly well with the umami and sweetness of the seikogani.





After the heaviness from the former courses, I am finally presented with something refreshing. A mini chirashi don is served to me, which contains akami and kamatoro cuts of tuna from Boston, madai from Ōita, buri from Hokkaido, and katsuo from Nagasaki. The use of shiso and kanpyō counters the unctuousness of katsuo, buri, and kamatoro. The issue here is that the kanpyō could be a little bit over-sweetened. Moreover, the rice is not very well executed. It is overcooked thus resulting in the loss of texture and higher-than-expectation stickiness.

The heaviness continues to the next dish consists of Miyazaki A5 wagyu momoniku, amadare sauce, and egg yolk. The Miyazaki A5 wagyu per se is already full of unctuousness, not to mention the most tender thigh part, aka the momoniku. The meatball is lightly pan-seared so that the outer layer has a burning and smoky aroma while the inner part is still raw. The amadare sauce is usually for eel and is rich in all the flavors: brininess, sweetness, and umami. The egg yolk adds another layer of creaminess to the amalgam, and the truffle introduces depths of aroma. Overall the flavor is great, but soon after second or third bite, it is hard to not neglect the greasiness.





The final dish is a cold soba noodle dish with sukiyaki style sirloin of the Miyazaki A5 wagyu beef. The noodle is cooked perfectly to al dente, and the beef per se is well executed. The addition of togarashi pepper is subtle, but successfully adds another dimensions of flavor to the simple dish. It is just that the use of such high-quality wagyu may result in greasiness, and no element in the noodle soup is to counter the unctuousness of the wagyu. It is also hard to understand that two out of the five savory dishes are actually shokuji courses. It could be that the chef is worrying that some customers may not be full after five courses so he applies both rice and noodle into his menu.

The final dessert features traditional Japanese milk ice cream with black sugar, with the addition of kumquat and mille-feuille crumbles. The contrasting flavors and textures are the key elements of the success of the dish. The refreshing aroma of the kumquat and the depth of dark sugar are well-balanced, and the creamy texture of ice cream and the crunchiness of the pastry also brings satisfaction to my palate. Overall, the lunch menu is well prepared, except that the high percentage of wagyu and staple foods may be confusing.

